UNIVERSITY OF LONDON

BSc EXAMINATION 2023

For Internal Students of
Royal Holloway

DO NOT TURN OVER UNTIL TOLD TO BEGIN

CS3003: IT Project Management
CS3003R: IT Project Management – for FIRSTSIT/RESIT CANDIDATES

Time Allowed: **TWO** hours

Please answer **ALL** questions

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1.

(a) In the context of project budgeting, discuss the difference between contingency and management reserves.

[10 marks]

(b) You are the Project Manager in a software development project that is expected to run for three months and consists of two major activities, namely Activity A and Activity B.

The actual cost of Activity A is £20,000 and the actual cost of Activity B is £10,000. The planned value for these activities is £18,000 and £8,000 respectively. Activity A is 100% complete. However, Activity B is only 75% complete.

Using **earned-value management**, indicate which of the following statements is correct about the project. **Justify** your answer.

- The project is ahead of schedule and over budget
- The project is ahead of schedule and under budget
- The project is behind schedule and over budget
- The project is behind schedule and under budget

[15 marks]

(c) You are the Project Manager in a software project that is running behind schedule by one week due to some minor defects. However, it is very important that the project finishes on-time. The project finish date is two months away. You are confident that you can recover the existing delay during the next month. A project Steering Committee (SC) meeting is scheduled in two days. Which of the following is the most appropriate way to report the status of the project to the SC? Briefly **justify** your answer.

- Report that “the project is on schedule” given that the delay is not significant and you are confident that you will recover it
- Report that “the project is on schedule” with a note that there may be some minor defects to be resolved
- Report that “the project is one week behind schedule” and explain the way the delay will be recovered
- Report that “the project is one week behind schedule”

[9 marks]

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2.

(a) Indicate whether each of the following statements is **true** or **false**. Briefly **justify** your answers.

(i) Unknown risks can be managed proactively.

(ii) A risk register evolves over the lifetime of the project.

(iii) A part of the stakeholder register defines who is responsible to share information regarding project risks.

(iv) Contingency plans are predefined actions that the project team will take if an identified risk event occurs.

(v) A project issue is an uncertain event that may or may not occur.

[10 marks]

(b) The activities of a project and respective durations and dependencies are shown in the following table.

Activity	Duration (weeks)	Predecessors
A	4	-
B	3	A
C	2	B
D	1	C
E	2	B
F	8	E
G	10	D
H	3	B
I	3	B
J	4	F,G,I
K	3	H
L	3	J,K
M	1	L

(i) Draw a network diagram for this project including all floats. [9 marks]

(ii) Mark the project's critical path on the diagram. [4 marks]

(c) Briefly explain the two main strategies that may be applied to rollout an IT system. Discuss two risks of each strategy.

[10 marks]

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3.

(a) In the context of project quality, explain the main differences between quality assurance and project assurance.

[8 marks]

(b) You are managing a software development project which should be completed in 12 months according to the project contract and schedule. The customer has recently faced regulatory changes that require the project to be finished 1 month earlier and asks you to do so. Which of the following is the most appropriate way to deal with the case? Briefly **justify** your answer.

- Accept the customer's request and remove specific parts of the initial project scope to meet the new deadline
- Inform the customer of the impact of the requirement and, after getting the required approvals, crash the project
- Accept the customer's request and reduce the duration of all project activities to meet the new deadline
- Keep the original project schedule given that a signed contract exists, which should not change

[8 marks]

(c) Two software developers of your team are involved in a serious conflict. It is apparent that the conflict is based on different interpretations of the project's scope. Which of the following resolution approaches would you apply in this case? Briefly **justify** your answer.

- Compromise
- Accept/Do nothing
- Impose a judgement
- Defuse

[8 marks]

(d) One of the responsibilities of an IT Project Manager is to ensure that appropriate documentation is handed over at the rollout/go-live phase of a project, for instance, the go-live "sign-off" document. Indicate any other three documents that should also be handed over at the rollout/go-live phase of an IT Project. Explain the purpose of each of these documents.

[9 marks]

END

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